India & Angola

Strengthening Partnership, Shaping Shared Growth

TRADE | INVESTMENT | ENERGY | INFRASTRUCTURE
PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE TIES | SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

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Foreword

Angola is one of Africa's largest and most resource-rich economies. With a population of around 37 million, a coastline of some 1,600 kilometres on the South Atlantic, vast reserves of oil and gas, diamonds, iron ore, copper, phosphates and other minerals, and large areas of fertile land, it is the third-largest economy in sub-Saharan Africa and a pivotal state of Southern and Central Africa. Having emerged from decades of conflict in 2002, Angola is now pursuing the diversification of its economy beyond hydrocarbons, the modernisation of its infrastructure, including the Lobito rail corridor, and the opening of its markets to new partners. At the same time, dependence on oil revenues, high external debt service, a history of currency volatility, infrastructure gaps, bureaucratic and payment-related risks, and the approach of the 2027 general elections are realities that must be carefully weighed when assessing commercial opportunities.

India and Angola share a relationship rooted in India's support for the Angolan independence struggle, diplomatic relations established in 1985, a vibrant energy partnership and, most recently, the State visit of President João Lourenço to India in May 2025. Bilateral trade of around US$ 4.2 billion is dominated by Angolan crude oil, which accounts for about nine-tenths of the total, while India's exports of pharmaceuticals, vehicles and parts, engineering goods, plastics and refined products offer a base for diversification. Both governments have expressed a clear wish to broaden the relationship into health, agriculture and food processing, mining, infrastructure, digital services, defence and training. India's competitive strengths in affordable medicines, machinery, agricultural technology, renewable energy, IT and capacity-building complement Angola's priorities and its role as a gateway to Southern and Central Africa.

This knowledge paper has been prepared by CCI India to help Indian businesses, institutions and policymakers make informed, practical and risk-aware decisions about engagement with Angola. It sets out sector opportunities, regulatory and financial considerations, risk-management practices and an action agenda for 2026-2030. Information reflects conditions as of October 2026, which remain fluid, and readers should verify current developments and obtain professional advice before committing resources.



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Table of Contents

1. Angola: Economic Profile and Business Environment 9
   1.1 Country overview 9
   1.2 Structure of the economy 9
   1.3 Regional role 9
   1.4 Trade arrangements 10
   1.5 Business environment summary 10
   1.6 Trade basket 10
2. Political, Macroeconomic and Reform Context 11
   2.1 Political system 11
   2.2 Leadership and recent developments 11
   2.3 The macroeconomic position 11
   2.4 The reform agenda 12
   2.5 Scenarios to 2030 12
   2.6 Indicators to monitor 13
   2.7 What this means for Indian business 13
3. Strategic Context of India–Angola Relations 13
   3.1 A relationship rooted in solidarity 13
   3.2 Diplomatic and institutional presence 13
   3.3 Energy partnership 14
   3.4 Development and defence cooperation 14
   3.5 Dimensions of the relationship 14
   3.6 Strategic logic 15
4. India: Capabilities Relevant to Angola 15
   4.1 Pharmaceuticals and healthcare 15
   4.2 Vehicles, machinery and engineering 15
   4.3 Agriculture, food and agro-processing 15
   4.4 Energy, refining and renewable power 15
   4.5 Mining services and gems 15
   4.6 IT, digital services and education 16
5. Trade Framework, Baseline and Market Access 16
   5.1 The current framework 16
   5.2 Establishing a baseline 17
   5.3 Market-access considerations 17
   5.4 Angola as a regional distribution platform 18
   5.5 Sources of growth 18
6. Food, Agriculture and Fisheries 18
   6.1 Potential and import dependence 18
   6.2 Opportunities for Indian products and services 18
   6.3 Opportunities for Angolan products in India 19

6.4 Agri-investment and value addition 19
6.5 Quality and compliance 19
7. Pharmaceuticals, Health and Medical Cooperation 20
7.1 Health system context 20
7.2 Regulatory pathway 20
7.3 Opportunities 20
7.4 Challenges 20
8. Oil, Gas, Energy and Power 21
8.1 Energy context 21
8.2 Indian strengths 21
8.3 Project types 21
8.4 Local content and the energy transition 22
9. Mining, Minerals and Diamonds 22
9.1 Sector context 22
9.2 Opportunities 22
9.3 Considerations 23
10. Infrastructure, Construction and Urban Services 23
10.1 Needs and context 23
10.2 Indian capabilities 23
10.3 Procurement and financing 24
10.4 Conditions for engagement 24
11. ICT, Business Services and Digital Government 24
11.1 Opportunity 24
11.2 Opportunity areas 24
11.3 Regulatory aspects 25
12. Fintech, Banking, Payments and Financial Inclusion 25
12.1 Why it matters 25
12.2 Opportunity areas 25
12.3 Regulation 26
13. Manufacturing, Industry and Small Enterprises 26
13.1 Sector overview 26
13.2 Indian opportunities 26
13.3 Small and medium enterprises 26
14. Tourism and Hospitality 27
14.1 Angola's tourism economy 27
14.2 Opportunities 27
15. Education, Skills and Research 28
15.1 The education landscape 28
15.2 Opportunities 28
15.3 Skills priorities 28

15.4 Mobility and recognition 29
16. Culture, Diaspora and Shared Heritage 29
16.1 Heritage as a bridge 29
16.2 Cultural and creative industries 29
16.3 The Portuguese-language bridge 30
16.4 Intellectual property and creators 30
17. Angola as a Gateway to Southern and Central Africa 30
17.1 The hub thesis 30
17.2 Regional market overview 30
17.3 Gateway functions 31
17.4 The Lobito Corridor 31
17.5 Limits 31
18. Ports, Logistics and Shipping 31
18.1 Distance and routes 31
18.2 Route and mode options 32
18.3 Cost and time levers 32
18.4 Resilience 32
19. Trade Finance, Payments and Currency 32
19.1 Payment architecture 32
19.2 Currency 33
19.3 Development finance 33
20. Legal, Tax and Compliance Framework 33
20.1 Legal environment 33
20.2 Land and property 33
20.3 Tax and incentives 33
20.4 Core compliance elements 34
21. Investment Promotion and Funding Vehicles 34
21.1 Investment climate 34
21.2 Target investment themes 35
22. Risk Management and Staged Market Entry 35
22.1 Risk register 35
22.2 Insurance and safeguards 36
22.3 Travel and duty of care 36
23. Institutions, Diplomacy and Business Networks 36
23.1 Institutional architecture 36
23.2 A bilateral business council 37
23.3 Cooperation with Indian bodies 37
Conclusion 38

ANGOLA

> Discover coastal beauty and cultural richness, where traditions and growth shape a rising nation.



Basic Facts & Economic Overview

Angola is a resource-rich country located on the southwestern coast of Africa, with Luanda as its capital and economic center. As of 2025 estimates, Angola's population is approximately 36–37 million. The official language is Portuguese, and the national currency is the Angolan Kwanza (AOA).

Angola is classified as a lower-middle-income economy but remains highly dependent on its oil sector. The country emerged from a prolonged civil war in 2002, after which it experienced rapid economic growth driven primarily by oil exports. Despite its natural resource wealth, Angola continues to face structural challenges such as income inequality, high unemployment, and limited diversification.

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

As of 2025 projections, Angola's nominal GDP is estimated to be around USD 110–125 billion. The economic structure is heavily skewed toward oil, which accounts for nearly 30–35% of GDP and over 90% of exports.

- Industry (Oil & Mining): Contributes around 50% of GDP in Angola, driving exports and overall economic growth.
- Services: Accounts for approximately 35–40%, supported by sectors like trade, banking, and telecommunications.
- Agriculture: Makes up about 10–15%, important for employment and food security despite lower development.

Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Angola share growing diplomatic and economic relations. Indian investments in Angola are focused on oil, infrastructure, and pharmaceuticals. Angola is also part of India's broader engagement with Africa through development cooperation and lines of credit.

While people-to-people ties are limited compared to South Asia, the relationship is expanding through business exchanges and technical cooperation.



Cultural & Heritage

Angola has a diverse cultural heritage shaped by ethnic groups like the Ovimbundu, Mbundu, and Bakongo. Traditional music and dance such as semba, along with storytelling and handicrafts, are central to its identity, while Portuguese influence is reflected in language, religion, and architecture.



Import and Export from India

Imports:

Key Import Products: Pharmaceuticals, rice, machinery, automobiles, engineering goods, textiles, and refined petroleum products.

Key Players in Import: Indian exporters, Angolan distribution networks, and public sector entities involved in healthcare and infrastructure.

Exports:

Key Export Products: Crude oil (major share), LNG (minor), diamonds

Key Players in Export: National oil company Sonangol, international oil companies, and Indian energy firms

Bilateral Trade with India: A Growing Energy Partnership

Bilateral trade between India and Angola is largely driven by the energy sector, with Angola being one of India's important suppliers of crude oil. This makes oil imports the backbone of the trade relationship, ensuring energy security for India while contributing significantly to Angola's export revenues. In return, India exports a range of goods including pharmaceuticals, machinery, vehicles, textiles, and agricultural products.

Although the overall trade volume remains moderate, both countries have been making efforts to strengthen economic cooperation beyond oil. There is growing collaboration in areas such as infrastructure development, mining, capacity building, and technical assistance. India has also supported Angola through lines of credit and development projects, which further enhance bilateral ties. With increasing engagement and mutual interest, the partnership holds strong potential for diversification and long-term growth.

Conclusion — Summary & Recommendation

To strengthen ties, both countries should focus on:

- Diversification into agriculture and manufacturing
- Infrastructure investment
- Technology transfer

A broader economic engagement will ensure long-term sustainability and reduce dependence on oil price fluctuations.



1. Angola: Economic Profile and Business Environment

1.1 Country overview

Angola is the seventh-largest country in Africa, with a long Atlantic coast, a fertile central plateau and abundant water, minerals and farmland. After the end of its civil war in 2002 the country rebuilt rapidly on the back of oil revenues, and today it is the third-largest economy in sub-Saharan Africa. Luanda, the capital, is a large and expensive commercial city and the centre of government, finance and trade. Secondary hubs include Lobito and Benguela on the coast, Huambo and Lubango in the highlands, Cabinda in the north and Namibe in the south.

The population is around 37 million, young and increasingly urban. Portuguese is the official language and is spoken by most Angolans, alongside several Bantu languages. Angola is classified as a lower-middle-income country, with sharp inequality between a prosperous urban minority and large numbers living in poverty.

1.2 Structure of the economy

- **Oil and gas:** the largest source of exports, fiscal revenue and foreign exchange, with mature offshore production gradually declining and new investment and refining projects under way.
- **Mining:** diamonds, iron ore, phosphates, copper, gold and emerging interest in rare earths and battery minerals.
- **Agriculture and fisheries:** large potential in cassava, maize, coffee, bananas, horticulture, livestock and fisheries, with farming still largely smallholder-based.
- **Construction and infrastructure:** roads, rail, ports, housing, water and power are major investment themes.
- **Trade and services:** retail, wholesale, transport, telecommunications, banking and professional services, which now lead non-oil growth.
- **Manufacturing and agro-industry:** beverages, food, cement, steel products and light industry, supported by import-substitution policies.
- **Energy and utilities:** large hydropower capacity, growing solar investment and major gaps in grid access.

1.3 Regional role

Angola is a member of the Southern African Development Community and the African Union, and its President chaired the African Union in 2025. It is an important actor in the Great Lakes and Southern African diplomacy and a growing logistics bridge through the Lobito Corridor, which links the Atlantic port of Lobito by rail to the mineral belts of the Democratic Republic of the Congo and Zambia. Luanda is a hub for the oil-service industry, and Angola's Portuguese-language connections link it with Brazil, Portugal and the Portuguese-speaking world.

1.4 Trade arrangements

Angola is a member of the World Trade Organization and the Southern African Development Community, and participates in the African Continental Free Trade Area process. Its customs tariff is applied under national legislation, with import duties, value-added tax and selective excise; the government uses tariffs and import controls to promote local production in some sectors. There is no preferential trade agreement between India and Angola, so Indian goods enter on a most-favoured-nation basis.

1.5 Business environment summary

Factor	Observation	Implication
Market size	Large population with growing urban demand and import dependence	Wide opportunity for consumer, industrial and capital goods
Currency and FX	Stable kwanza since 2024 after earlier sharp depreciation; FX access has improved but can be slow	Secured settlement and flexible payment planning
Connectivity	Large ports and a new international airport; indirect links to India	Logistics and routing planning
Language	Portuguese dominates; limited English	Portuguese-language marketing, documents and partners
Costs	Luanda is among the most expensive cities for business	Local partnerships and lean presence
Skills	Young workforce with significant skills gaps	Training and technology-transfer partnerships
Governance	Reform programme; bureaucracy and payment delays persist	Strong contracts and local advisors
Infrastructure	Large deficits in power, water, roads and logistics	Demand for equipment, construction and services

1.6 Trade basket

Angola exports crude oil and gas, refined products, diamonds, iron and steel scrap, copper, coffee and fish. It imports food (including meat, cereals, rice, sugar and dairy), vehicles, machinery, electrical equipment, pharmaceuticals, chemicals, plastics, textiles, construction materials and refined fuel. Exports are heavily concentrated in energy, and the import basket matches many of India's most competitive products.